

SIMPLE,
COMPOUND, COMPLEX,
& COMPOUND COMPLEX
SENTENCES

SIMPLE	COMPOUND	COMPLEX	COMPOUND COMPLEX
1 VERB	1+1 VERB	1+1/2 VERB	1+1+1/2 VERB
I went to the shop. (Beware of verbals -ing words/ infinitives/to+ verbs)	I went to the shop and I bought apples. I bought apples but I did not buy milk.	I went to the shop which Is near my house when I got home.	I went to the shop and I bought apples although They were expensive.
			

UNDERSTANDING NON-VERBS

NON-VERBS/ VERBALS/ VERBAL IMPOSTERS/ LOOKALIKES

GERUND	PARTICIPLE	INFINITIVE
x-ing (swimming)	x-ing (swimming)	to+verb (to swim)
NOUN	ADJECTIVE	NOUN

- Swimming is a good exercise.
- I love to swim.
- Swimming ducks are fun to watch/ Watching ducks is a fun.
- Leaping dolphins are a great sight to behold, but fishing is what I like.
- We are planning to visit the thundering waterfalls and then go boating.
- On finding no one to play with, the child began crying and his caring mother got him an ice-cream.
- A cracking sound broke the singing in the room.
- Trolling in the internet was Mohan's fascinating obsession till he had to pay a high price for it.
- (Trolling on the internet, Mohan was caught.

Synthesis of sentences

Look at the following sentences:

1. The thief heard a shout.

2. He ran away.

Hearing a shout, the thief ran away

The first two sentences are combined into a single sentence in the third one. This process is called Synthesis. It is just the opposite of Analysis. Synthesis means the combination of two or more Simple sentences into one new sentence- Simple, Compound or Complex.

Ways of Combining Two or More Simple Sentences into One Simple Sentence

1. By using a Participle

This is possible only when the sentences have a common Subject.

1. I read the book. I returned it to the Library.

Having read the book I returned it to the Library.

2. The farmer jumped on his horse. He rode to the market.

Jumping on his horse the farmer rode to the market.

3. He opened the gate. He took the dog out for a run.

Opening the gate he took the dog out for a run.

4. Henry planted a rose. He watered it. He manured it. He was delighted to see it beginning to flower.

Having planted a rose, and watered and manured it, Henry was delighted to see it beginning to flower.

2. By using the Absolute Construction

This is done when the sentences have different Subjects:

1. The President took his seat on the dais. The meeting began.

The President having taken his seat on the dais, the meeting began.

2. The storm subsided. we began our march again.

The storm having subsided, we began our march again.

3. The monsoon started. The village roads became muddy.

The monsoon having started, the village roads became muddy.

4. The examination was over. The College was closed. The students left for their homes. The Campus looked deserted.

The examination being over, the College being closed and students having left for their homes, the Campus looked deserted.

3. By using an Infinitive

1. I have some work. I must do it tonight.

I have some work to do tonight.

2. You must help your brother. It is your duty.

It is your duty to help your brother.

3. It is very heavy. I cannot lift it.

It is too heavy for me to lift.

4. He got enough foreign exchange. He could go to London for the conference.

He could also visit America.

He got enough foreign exchange to go to London for the conference and also to visit America.

4. By using a Noun or Phrase in Apposition

1. Rama defeated Ravana. Ravana was the King of Lanka.

Rama defeated Ravana, the King of Lanka.

2. Mr. Reddy is my tenant. He pays the rent regularly.

Mr. Reddy, my tenant, pays the rent regularly.

3. He won the first prize in Long Jump, High Jump and Pole-vault. It was a glorious performance.

He won the first prize in Long Jump, High Jump and Pole Vault-a glorious performance.

4. Stalin was the Dictator of Russia. He had talks with Roosevelt and Churchill. Roosevelt was the President of the United States. Churchill was the Prime Minister of Britain.

Stalin, the Dictator of Russia, had talks with Roosevelt, the President of the United States, and Churchill, the Prime Minister of Britain.

5. By using a Preposition + a Noun or a Gerund

1. He had many faults. But he was a good man at heart.

In spite of having many faults, he was a good man at heart

2. Rossetti was a painter. He was also a poet.

Besides being a painter, Rossetti was also a poet.

3. He had a great deal of influence. But he could not get the job.

With all his influence he could not get the job.

6. By using an Adverb or an Adverbial Phrase

1. He will win the election. That is certain.

He will certainly win the election.

2. They decided to wind up the company. All agreed to this.

They unanimously decided to wind up the company.

By common consent they decided to wind up the company

3. There was an epidemic of cholera in the village. The doctor worked hard. He had no rest. He had none to assist him.

During the epidemic of cholera in the village the doctor worked hard without any rest and with none to assist him. Note.

Note:

- Several of these methods can be usefully combined in the same sentence:
- 1. Ashok had an interview with Mr. Dean. Mr. Dean was the British Consu. Ashok requested him to grant him a Visa. He wanted to go to England. His aim was to do his F.R.C.S.

During his interview with Mr. Dean, the British Consul, Ashok requested him to grant him a visa to go to England in order to do his F.R.C.S.

Test your skills:

Combine the following using Participles

1. He hurt his foot. He stopped.
2. He gave up his situation. He was not satisfied with his salary.
3. He felt tired. He laid his work aside.
4. He went straight on. He saw Hari on the path.
5. The stable door was open. The horse was stolen.
6. The hunter took up his gun. He went out to shoot the lion.
7. I went to Mumbai last year. I wished to see a dentist.
8. A crow stole a piece of cheese. She flew to her nest to enjoy the tasty meal.

Answers:

1. Hurting his foot, he stopped.
2. Not being satisfied with his salary, he gave up his situation.
3. Feeling tired, he laid his work aside.
4. Going straight on, he saw Hari on the path.
5. With the stable door open, the horse was stolen.
6. Taking up his gun, the hunter went out to shoot the lion.
7. Wishing to see a dentist, I went to Mumbai last year.
8. Stealing a piece of cheese, the crow flew to her nest to enjoy the tasty meal.

Combine using Nouns or Phrases in Apposition:

1. There goes my brother. He is called Sourabh.
2. Coal is a very important mineral. It is hard, bright, black and brittle.
3. We saw the picture. It is a very fine piece of work.
4. Chaucer was born in 1340. he is the first great English poet.
5. Tagore's most famous work is the Gitanjali. It is a collection of short poems.
6. His only son died before him. He was a lad of great promise.
7. His uncle was a millionaire. He sent him to England for his education.
8. The dog bit the man. He was a notorious burglar.

Answers:

1. There goes my brother, Sourabh.
2. Coal, a hard, bright, black, and brittle mineral, is very important.
3. We saw the picture, a very fine piece of work.
4. Chaucer, the first great English poet, was born in 1340.
5. Tagore's most famous work, the Gitanjali, is a collection of short poems.
6. His only son, a lad of great promise, died before him.
7. His uncle, a millionaire, sent him to England for his education.
8. The dog bit the man, a notorious burglar.

Combine the following using Prepositions with Nouns or Gerunds:

- He attended to his duties. He earned promotion.
- He must confess his fault. He may thus escape punishment.
- He was ill last term. He was unable to attend school.
- I forgave him for his fault. That has not prevented him from repeating it.
- The bugle sounded. The weary soldiers leapt to their feet.
- The word of command will be given. You will then fire.
- He sets traps every night. He cleared his house of rats.
- The judge gave his decision. The court listened silently.

Answers:

1. By attending to his duties, he earned a promotion.
2. By confessing his fault, he may escape punishment.
3. Due to being ill last term, he was unable to attend school.
4. Despite forgiving him for his fault, it has not prevented him from repeating it.
5. At the sound of the bugle, the weary soldiers leapt to their feet.
6. Upon receiving the word of command, you will fire.
7. By setting traps every night, he cleared his house of rats.
8. Upon the judge giving his decision, the court listened silently.

Combine the following using the Nominative Absolute construction:

- His friend arrived. He was very pleased.
- The rain fell. The crops revived.
- The storm ceased. The sun came out.
- The troops were ordered out. The police were unable to hold the mob in check.
- The holidays are at an end. Boys are returning to school.
- The prisoner was questioned. No witness came forward. The judge dismissed the case.

Answers:

1. His friend having arrived, he was very pleased.
2. The rain having fallen, the crops revived.
3. The storm having ceased, the sun came out.
4. The troops being ordered out, the police were unable to hold the mob in check.
5. The holidays being at an end, boys are returning to school.
6. The prisoner having been questioned and no witness coming forward, the judge dismissed the case.

Combine the following using infinitives:

- He had no money. He could not give any away.
- I have told you all. There is nothing more to be said.
- He cannot afford a motor-car. He is too poor.
- I heard of his good fortune. I was glad of that.
- The information is of no use. It has come too late.
- Your father will hear of your success. He will be delighted.
- You did not invest your savings in one concern. You were prudent.

Answers:

1. He had no money to give away.
2. I have told you all there is to say.
3. He is too poor to afford a motor-car.
4. I was glad to hear of his good fortune.
5. The information has come too late to be of use.
6. Your father will be delighted to hear of your success.
7. You were prudent not to invest your savings in one concern.

Combine using adverbs or adverbial phrases:

- I accept your statement. I do it without reserve.
- He answered me. His answer was correct.
- He forgot his umbrella. That was careless.
- He is a bad boy. This is certain.
- The train is very late. That is usual.
- I shall come back. I shall not be long.
- He kicked the goal-keeper. It was his intention to do so.
- He was obstinate. He refused to listen to advice.

Answers:

1. I accept your statement without reserve.
2. He answered me correctly.
3. He carelessly forgot his umbrella.
4. He is certainly a bad boy.
5. The train is usually very late.
6. I shall come back shortly.
7. He intentionally kicked the goal-keeper.
8. He obstinately refused to listen to advice.

Simple to Compound

The four Co-ordinating Conjunctions

- Cumulative (both.. And, not only... but also, and)
Merely adds one statement with another
- Adversative (still, yet, however, nevertheless)
Expresses contrast or opposition between statements
- Alternative (or, either, neither, nor, either..or, neither..nor)
Expressing choice between two alternatives
- Illative (therefore, so, for)
Conjunctions which express an inference

Simple to Compound

Using conjunctions which merely add one sentence to another

1. Ravi woke up. He brushed his teeth. He made coffee. He drank it.

Ravi woke up, brushed his teeth, made coffee and drank it.

2. Radha is good at studies. She is also a great athlete.

Radha is **not only** good at studies **but also** a great athlete.

Using conjunctions which join contrasting statements

1. Simon is a wanderer. He is not lost.

Simon is a wanderer **but** he is not lost.

2. There was little hope of success. They decided to perform the operation.

There was little hope of success, **nevertheless** they decided to perform the operation.

Simple to Compound

Using conjunctions which bring together alternative facts, viewpoints or statements

1. You must stay for lunch. You must come back for dinner.

You must **either** stay for lunch **or** come back for dinner.

2. One has to struggle early in life. One will not have equanimity.

One has to struggle early in life, **otherwise** one will not have equanimity.

Using conjunctions employed in inferential statements (e.g. so, for, therefore, etc.)

1. The power must be out. The streetlights are not on.

The power must be out, **for** the streetlights are not on.

2. The boys have looked forward to this event. They will do well.

The boys have looked forward to this event, **so/therefore**, they will do well.

Combine the following Simple Sentences into Compound:

- He does well. He is nervous at the start.
- The way was long. The wind was cold.
- It is raining heavily. I will take an umbrella with me.
- The harvest truly is plenteous. The labourers are few.
- It was a stormy night. We ventured out.
- He is foolish. He is also obstinate.
- I am in the right. You are in the wrong.
- He completed his work early. He went out for a walk.

Answers:

1. He does well, but he is nervous at the start.
2. The way was long, and the wind was cold.
3. It is raining heavily, so I will take an umbrella with me.
4. The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few.
5. It was a stormy night, yet we ventured out.
6. He is foolish, and he is also obstinate.
7. I am in the right, while you are in the wrong.
8. He completed his work early, and he went out for a walk.

Can you take a few more?

1. A is equal to B. B is equal to C. A is equal to C.
2. Most of the rebels were slain. A few escaped. They hid in the woods and the marshes. The rebellion was quickly suppressed.
3. He was my school-fellow. He has become a great man. He has grown proud. He forgets his old friends.
4. I did not see you. I should have spoken to you. I had important news. Delay is dangerous.
5. The monsoon failed. The tanks became almost empty. No grain could be sown. A famine was feared. The ryots looked anxiously for the next monsoon. It proved unusually abundant. The danger was averted.

Answers:

1. A is equal to B, and B is equal to C, so A is equal to C.
2. Most of the rebels were slain, but a few escaped and hid in the woods and the marshes; the rebellion was quickly suppressed.
3. He was my school-fellow and has become a great man, but he has grown proud and forgets his old friends.
4. If I had seen you, I would have spoken to you because I had important news, and delay is dangerous.
5. The monsoon failed, the tanks became almost empty, and no grain could be sown, so a famine was feared. However, the ryots anxiously looked for the next monsoon, which proved unusually abundant, and the danger was averted.

Simple to Complex

Using a noun clause

1. We come in peace. That should be made known to everyone.

That we come in peace should be made known to everyone. [subject]

(or: It should be made known to everyone **that we come in peace**.)

2. He had made us all proud. We told him that.

We told him **that he had made us all proud**. [object of 'told']

3. Where should we buy the costumes for the sports meet drama? That is the question.

The question is **where we should buy the costumes for the sports meet drama** [complement of 'is'].

4. They decided to do so. She was shocked about that.

She was shocked about **what they decided to do** [object of the preposition 'about'].

Simple to Complex

Using an adjective clause (introduced by relative pronouns *who*(se, m) , *which* and *that* or the relative adverbs *when*, *where* and *why*)

1. The boy was caught. He had stolen the watch.

The boy **who** had stolen the watch was caught.

2. The gentleman arrived yesterday. His name is Sir Walter Harris.

The gentleman **whose** name is Walter Harris arrived yesterday.

3. This is a rare chance. You should not miss it.

This is a rare chance (**that/which**) you should not miss.

4. We refused to go on vacation. We could not tell anyone the reason.

We could not tell anyone the reason **why** we refused to go on vacation.

5. The boy was excited about his birthday party.

The boy, **who** was excited, looked forward to his birthday party.

Simple to Complex

Using an adverb clause (connected by subordinating conjunctions like *when, as, since, till, where, if, though, unless, that, lest, whether, whereas* etc.)

1. I went to the station. The train was leaving.

As/when I reached the station, the train was leaving.

(or: The train was leaving, as and when we reached the station.)

2. Let them wait outside. We will wind up this meeting,

Let them wait outside **while/until** we wind up this meeting.

3. Henry tiptoed into the church. He did not want to disrupt the mass.

Henry tiptoed into the church **lest** he should disrupt the mass.

4. This is the crossroads. We part ways here.

This is the crossroads **where** we part ways.

Simple to Complex

Using an adverb clause (connected by subordinating conjunctions like *when, as, since, till, where, if, though, unless, that, lest, whether, whereas* etc.)

5. John has to lose weight. Otherwise, he will not be able to run.

Unless John loses weight, he will not be able to run.

(or: The train was leaving, as and when we reached the station.)

6. Prabhu is full of bookish knowledge. His sister, however, is street-smart.

Whereas Prabhu is full of bookish knowledge, his sister is street-smart.

7. He can turn his life around. He just has to try hard.

If he tries hard, he can turn his life around.

8. The guests may be delayed. They are not sure.

They are not sure **whether** the guests would be delayed.

Combine the Simple sentence into Complex using Noun Clause:

1. He is wrong. I am sure of it.
2. You deceived him. That was his complaint.
3. All the planets except Pluto travel round the sun the same way and in the same plane. I have often told you this truth.
4. He will waste his time. That is certain.
5. Who wrote Shakuntala? Can you tell me that?
6. How did Subhash Chandra Bose die? It is a mystery.

Answers:

1. I am sure that he is wrong.
2. His complaint was that you deceived him.
3. I have often told you that all the planets except Pluto travel around the sun in the same way and in the same plane.
4. It is certain that he will waste his time.
5. Can you tell me who wrote Shakuntala?
6. It is a mystery how Subhash Chandra Bose died.

Combine the following using an Adjective clause:

1. The theft was committed last night. The man has been caught.
2. The French and Italian languages are different from the Latin language.
Latin was once spoken in almost every part of Europe.
3. The time was six o'clock. The accident happened then.
4. You are not keeping good health lately. Can you tell me the reason?
5. He has many plans of making money quickly. All of them have failed.

Answers:

1. The man who committed the theft last night has been caught.
2. The French and Italian languages, which are different from the Latin language, were once spoken in almost every part of Europe.
3. The accident happened at six o'clock, which was the time.
4. Can you tell me the reason why you are not keeping good health lately?
5. He has many plans of making money quickly, all of which have failed.

Combine the following using Adverb Clause:

1. The nurse must be very tired. She had no sleep last night.
2. A gentleman may call. Please ask him to wait
3. He ran so quickly. He soon overtook me.
4. I will get ready. Do not go until then.
5. He spoke in a very low voice. Nobody could hear him.
6. I mended my watch this morning. It has stopped.
7. It was very stuffy last night. I could not sleep.

Answers:

1. The nurse must be tired, as she had no sleep last night.
2. If a gentleman calls, please ask him to wait.
3. He ran so quickly that he overtook me.
4. Do not go till I get ready.
5. As he spoke in a very low voice, nobody could hear him.
6. Although I mended my watch this morning, it has stopped.
7. As it was very stuffy, I could not sleep last night.

Test yourself!

1. You have failed. I am sorry to hear it. You deserve to pass. I think it.
2. You will be allowed to enter for the examination. Your working hard is a condition. The orders are to that effect. They were issued by the Principal.
3. They played the game very skilfully. No one could have played it more skilfully. They had been thoroughly well trained.
4. He is an idle and careless boy. The report was to this effect. His father received the report. He was very grieved to receive it.
5. You sow in a certain way. You will reap in the same way. The proverb says this.

How did you fare?

1. I am sorry to hear that you have failed, as I think that you deserved to pass.
2. The principal has issued orders to the effect that you will be allowed to enter for the examination if you work hard.
3. As they had been thoroughly well trained, they played the game at least as skilfully as anyone could have done.
4. His father was grieved to receive the report that he was more idle and careless than the other boys in school.
5. The proverb says that as you sow, so you reap.

1-Transforming Complex into Simple Sentence

1. Although she was late, she completed the assignment.
2. When the teacher arrived, the students stopped talking.
3. Since he is a doctor, he understands the importance of health.
4. If you study hard, you will pass the exam.
5. As soon as the movie started, the audience became silent.
6. Although he was injured, he continued playing the game.
7. After she finished her homework, she went out to play.
8. When the rain stopped, we went outside.
9. Because she was tired, she decided to take a nap.
10. Though it was raining heavily, we decided to go hiking.

Answers

1. Despite being late, she completed the assignment.
2. On the teacher's arrival, the students stopped talking.
3. Being a doctor, he understands the importance of health.
4. By studying hard, you will pass the exam.
5. At the start of the movie, the audience became silent.
6. In spite of his injury, he continued playing the game.
7. After completing her homework, she went out to play.
8. We went outside after the rain stopped.
9. Being tired, she decided to take a nap.
10. Despite the heavy rain, we decided to go hiking.

2-Transforming Complex into Simple Sentence

11.As soon as the sun rises, we will begin our journey.

12.If you follow the instructions, you will be able to complete the task easily.

13.Since the meeting was cancelled, they went home early.

14.When the storm ended, the children went outside to play.

15.As he is new to the job, he needs some guidance.

16.Though she didn't feel well, she attended the event.

17.After he finished his speech, everyone applauded.

18.Because the weather was pleasant, we went for a walk.

19.Since the train was delayed, we waited at the station.

20.Although the competition was tough, she managed to win.

Answers

11. At sunrise, we will begin our journey.
12. By following the instructions, you will complete the task easily.
13. With the meeting cancelled, they went home early.
14. After the storm ended, the children went outside to play.
15. Being new to the job, he needs some guidance.
16. Despite not feeling well, she attended the event.
17. On finishing his speech, everyone applauded.
18. With the weather pleasant, we went for a walk.
19. With the train delayed, we waited at the station.
20. Despite the tough competition, she managed to win.

1-Transforming Compound into Complex Sentence

1. She wanted to go to the party, but she had too much work to do.
2. The sun set, and the stars appeared in the sky.
3. I was feeling unwell, so I stayed at home.
4. She studied hard, and she passed the exam.
5. You can come with us, or you can meet us at the restaurant later.
6. I was late, yet they waited for me.
7. The car broke down, so we had to take a taxi.
8. She studied hard, and she passed the exam.
9. I wanted to help him, but he refused my offer.
10. The weather was bad, yet we decided to go on the trip.

Answers

1. She wanted to go to the party **although she had too much work to do.**
2. **After the sun set**, the stars appeared in the sky.
3. **Because I was feeling unwell**, I stayed at home.
4. She passed the exam **because she studied hard.**
5. You can come with us **if you want**, or you can meet us at the restaurant later.
6. **Even though I was late**, they waited for me.
7. The car broke down **so we had to take a taxi.**
8. She passed the exam **because she studied hard.**
9. I wanted to help him **although he refused my offer.**
10. **Even though the weather was bad**, we decided to go on the trip.

2-Transforming Compound into Complex Sentence

11. They invited us to their wedding, but we couldn't attend.
12. He worked all night, so he was very tired in the morning.
13. We went to the museum, and we learned a lot about history.
14. She forgot her umbrella, but she didn't get wet.
15. The train was delayed, so we missed the meeting.
16. He is rich, yet he lives a very simple life.
17. The movie was boring, so we left early.
18. She didn't study much, but she still managed to pass the test.
19. You should take a nap, or you will feel tired later.
20. He wanted to finish the project, but he didn't have enough time.

Answers

11.They invited us to their wedding **but we couldn't attend because of prior commitments.**

12.He was very tired in the morning **because he worked all night.**

13.We learned a lot about history **when we went to the museum.**

14.She didn't get wet **even though she forgot her umbrella.**

15.We missed the meeting **because the train was delayed.**

16.Although he is rich, he lives a very simple life.

17.Because the movie was boring, we left early.

18.Even though she didn't study much, she managed to pass the test.

19.You should take a nap **or else you will feel tired later.**

20.He wanted to finish the project **but didn't have enough time to complete it**

1-Transforming Simple into Compound Sentence

1. He worked hard to complete the project.
2. The rain was heavy, causing the match to be postponed.
3. She studied diligently for the exam.
4. He wanted to go to the party.
5. I was late for the meeting due to the traffic.
6. She didn't eat breakfast.
7. The sun was shining brightly.
8. They arrived early at the airport.
9. I wanted to help him with the assignment.
10. She saved money to buy a new laptop.

Answers

1. He worked hard, **and** he completed the project.
2. The rain was heavy, **so** the match was postponed.
3. She studied diligently for the exam, **and** she passed it with flying colors.
4. He wanted to go to the party, **but** he had other plans.
5. I was late for the meeting due to the traffic, **yet** I managed to present my report.
6. She didn't eat breakfast, **but** she had a big lunch.
7. The sun was shining brightly, **and** everyone enjoyed the day.
8. They arrived early at the airport, **so** they had time to relax.
9. I wanted to help him with the assignment, **but** he refused my offer.
10. She saved money, **and** she bought a new laptop.

2-Transforming Simple into Compound Sentence

1. We visited the museum last week.
2. He exercises daily to stay healthy.
3. She cooked dinner for the family.
4. I went for a walk in the park.
5. The book was interesting.
6. She bought the dress on sale.
7. I finished my homework quickly.
8. The bus was late today.
9. They went to the beach for the weekend.
10. I need to complete my work before evening.

Answers

11. We visited the museum last week, **and** we learned a lot about art.

12. He exercises daily, **and** he stays healthy.

13. She cooked dinner for the family, **and** everyone enjoyed the meal.

14. I went for a walk in the park, **and** I saw beautiful flowers.

15. The book was interesting, **so** I read it in one sitting.

16. She bought the dress on sale, **and** it was a great deal.

17. I finished my homework quickly, **so** I had time to watch TV.

18. The bus was late today, **but** I still arrived on time.

19. They went to the beach for the weekend, **and** they had a great time.

20. I need to complete my work, **or** I won't be able to leave before evening.

SAIRAM